A Question for DJT

Yesterday, Mr. President, you said that Volodymyr Zelenskyy was creating a "world problem" and that it would be better to replace him. If you can provide sufficiently compelling reasons, we Democrats would readily agree to replacing Zelenskyy as well. You receive extensive intelligence briefings from the country's leading intelligence agencies and have excellent advisers at your side, so surely you can make a rational decision.

All right. Let's suppose Zelenskyy is replaced. Mr. President, then what?

The front lines of the Russia–Ukraine war have become increasingly automated through advanced technologies such as drones, and they have barely moved in years. Ukraine still possesses significant military capabilities, enough to strike Russian oil refineries, and isn't that precisely why you are pressuring Ukraine right now? Unfortunately, I believe that any ceasefire negotiations will require persuading not only Russia but Ukraine as well. Mr. President, you said in 2023 that you knew how to end the war in Ukraine within 24 hours. What exactly is the secret formula you have up your sleeve for a ceasefire agreement that both Ukraine and Russia would accept?

There is, in fact, an easy option available. We could simply wait for Le Pen and the AfD to come to power in France and Germany, respectively, allow Ukraine to grow weaker, and then negotiate. A more divided European Union might also make trade negotiations easier for your administration. But does America's defense burden actually decrease? If a precedent is established in which Ukraine is forced to negotiate on unfavorable terms, what happens to Russia's other neighbors? Most Russian citizens believe that Russia is already engaged in an indirect war against Europe, extending well beyond Ukraine. Mr. President, do you consider that perception rational?

Now suppose Putin decides that limited military provocations against the Baltic states are militarily feasible. He could certainly find a pretext. Unlike Ukraine, whose president is himself a native Russian speaker, Estonia and Latvia have long denied automatic citizenship to some Russian-speaking residents, requiring them to meet specific naturalization conditions. Many experts consider these policies acceptable, but who knows how Putin might interpret them?

As Andrey Melnichenko's 2026 interviews with The Economist illustrate, major Russian businesses have adapted to an economy increasingly geared toward the war effort. Russia is already carrying out hybrid attacks across Europe, targeting defense manufacturers and critical infrastructure. In 2024, you said that you would encourage Russia to attack NATO members that failed to pay enough for their defense. If Russia were to launch a limited attack on a city in Estonia, would minimizing American support for the Baltic states really be in the United States' best interest?